PAIGE TOWNSEND

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Human-Computer Interaction student who leads user research and designs accessible, user-centered products in Figma. Experience in usability testing, interviews, WCAG-based accessibility auditing and remediation, and turning findings into clear design recommendations.

EDUCATION

University of California, Irvine **Expected Jun 2027**

B.S. in Informatics, Human-Computer Interaction Specialization

Relevant Coursework: Data Management, Human-Computer Interaction, Data Visualization, Project Management, Application Design

SKILLS

Research Methods: User Interviews, Usability Testing, Survey Design, Competitive Analysis, Persona Development

Design Tools: Figma, FigJam, Wireframing, High-Fidelity Prototyping, Reusable Components, Design Systems, Accessibility Audits

Technical: Python, Java, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, R, MySQL, Web APIs

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

INsite Lab + TLC Lab **Aug 2025 – Present**

UX Researcher and Designer, Interdisciplinary Research Fellow *Irvine, CA*

- **Lead accessibility research**, translating findings into wireframes, mockups, and design recommendations.
- Design and prototype Clarity Coach, a dashboard that **visualizes inaccessible language** in recorded lecture videos.
- Partner with a PhD student to transform ML-flagged phrases into visual feedback, backed by **usability testing with 11 professors.**

UC Irvine Department of Informatics **Sep 2026 – Present**

Course Reader, INF 121: Software Design: Applications *Irvine, CA*

- Grade **multi-week deliverables** for 82 students, applying structured rubrics across design studio projects and exams.
- **Align grading rubrics** with the course TA and fellow readers, and **resolve scoring inconsistencies and student grading concerns.**

UCI Division of Teaching Excellence and Innovation (DTEI) **Sep 2025 – Sep 2026**

Digital Accessibility (Consultant → Supervisor → Project Manager) *Irvine, CA*

- Led and mentored a team of 10+ consultants, setting the standard for **WCAG-aligned** remediation across **42 courses and 44 faculty members.**
- Coordinated **156 consultation sessions** supporting **133 faculty members**, scoping requests and prioritizing workload across the team.
- Supported faculty training on YuJa Panorama and accessibility workflows (assisted with Q&A and hands-on practice) to improve adoption of **inclusive teaching practices.**

CCC Security Center **Jul 2025 – Sep 2025**

SOC Analyst Intern *Santa Clarita, CA*

- Led a team in conceptualizing a Python script leveraging BitSight APIs to automate cybersecurity **threat detection**, applying open-source intelligence tools to **investigate incidents across 116 schools** state-wide.

PROJECTS

MUGIC Games+: INF 191 Capstone Project **Oct 2026 – Present**

- Collaborate with the sponsor and student team to scope a **motion-controlled game prototype** using MUGIC sensors.
- Research game concepts for players of varying abilities, with a focus on **usability**, **comfortable controls**, and **inclusive design**.
- Developed an in-depth Game Design Document outlining game concepts and mechanics, as well as initiated lo-fi UI design.

Kain Na!: FUSION ICS Project **Nov 2025 – May 2026**

- Partnered with a design team to build a cultural connection platform connecting Filipino Americans to their heritage through food.
- Led user interviews to **uncover community needs**, shaping a family recipe centered concept grounded in real user stories.
- Designed a **reusable recipe card component** surfacing key context at a glance: creator, prep duration, and dish origin.
- Built an **ingredient substitution search feature**, prioritizing clarity and accessibility for novice cooks navigating unfamiliar ingredients.

LEADERSHIP

Hack at UCI: Corporate Co-Director; VenusHacks: Co-President **Dec 2023 – Mar 2026**

- Directed sponsor relations across two UCI hackathons (400+ and 200+ annual participants), **raising $49,000+** combined and **managing 80+ sponsor relationships.**
- Led and mentored 8+ new organizers while co-directing a 40+ student team, **standardizing sponsorship documentation** and outreach pipelines used across both events.
- Oversaw a combined $10,000+ in event budget as Co-President of **UCI's only women-centric hackathon**, VenusHacks.